15 μεταμορφώσεις

by Olivia Lee

Ovid's *Metamorphoses* contains over 250 myths across 15 books, defying genre. Although the composition certainly meets some criteria to be labelled as an epic due to its length and meter, it departs from this singular label due to the varying themes, which can be found in epic, elegy, tragedy, and pastoral poetry. The mythic-history has a chronology, but Ovid moves from story to story with little relation from one to the other.

The two most important themes across the *Metamorphoses*, however, are love and change, which are common themes in my own writing.

15 μεταμορφώσεις is inspired by Ovid's *Metamorphoses*. It is composed from my collected creative writing, after it has been segmented into sentences and used to train a character-level Markov chain (N=5) that generates new text. Using probabilistic character sequences, I used the model to produce a number of line / sentence variations using beam width.

Beam width controls how many possible continuations the model keeps track of as it generates text. Instead of choosing a single next character at each step, the model explores multiple likely paths in parallel, which produces many alternative versions of the same underlying line, with a possibility for subtle shifts in tone and meaning.

In thinking about change, variation, and pathways, I saw how each line's many variations collectively contain a sentiment. Each outcome reads to me like a singular genre-bending poem. However, with many of them, there can be a narrative. After a number of generations, I culled, selected, and arranged them into a semi-chronological poetic narrative, leaving behind *15 μεταμορφώσεις*.

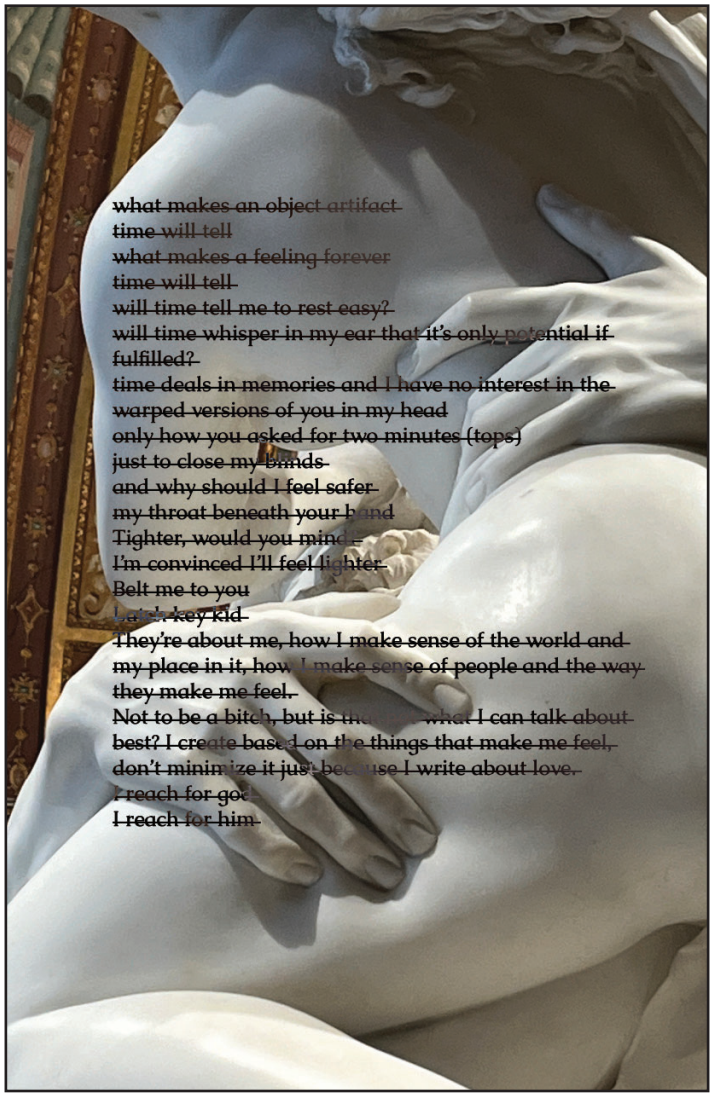
```
from shoestrings import TextGenerator
from shoestrings.tokenizers import SimpleWordTokenizer,
SimpleCharacterTokenizer
import sentencex
text = open(“./olee_writing_dirty.txt”).read()
sentences = sentencex.segment(“en”, text)
sentences = [item.replace(“\n”, “ “) for item in sentences if
len(item.strip()) > 0]
char_gen = TextGenerator(n=5, tokenizer=SimpleCharacterTokenizer(),
source=sentences)

for i in range(15):
   print(char_gen.generate(beam_width=25, temperature=3.0))
   print()
```

['though', 'though', 'though', 'though', 'though for me, were you? ', 'though for me, were you? ', 'though for me, were you? ', 'though for me, were you'll go.', 'though for me, were you'll go.', 'though you do.', 'though for me, were you've with your words grasp. ', 'though for me, were you've with your words grasp. ', 'though for me, were you've with your words grasp. ', 'though for me, were you've with your words grasp. ', 'though for me, were you've with your words grasp. ', 'though for me, were you've with your words grasp', 'though for me, were you've with your work. ', 'though for me, were you've with your words I can't beneath before.', 'though for me, were you've with your words I can't beneath before I started the on my pedestal I w', 'though for me, were you've with your words I can't beneath before I started the on my pedestal I w', 'though for me, were you've with your words I can't beneath before I started the on my pedestal I w', 'though for me, were you've with your words I can't beneath before I started the on my pedestal for', 'though for me, were you've with your words I can't beneath before I started the on my pedestal I t', 'though for me, were you've with your words I can't beneath before I started the on my pedestal', 'though for me, were you've with your words rings']

Sources:

"Metamorphoses." Wikipedia. Accessed March 20, 2026. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Metamorphoses.

Parrish, Allison. "Shoestrings Tutorial." Shoestrings Tutorial , 2024. https://github.com/aparrish/shoe-strings/blob/main/shoestrings-tutorial.ipynb.



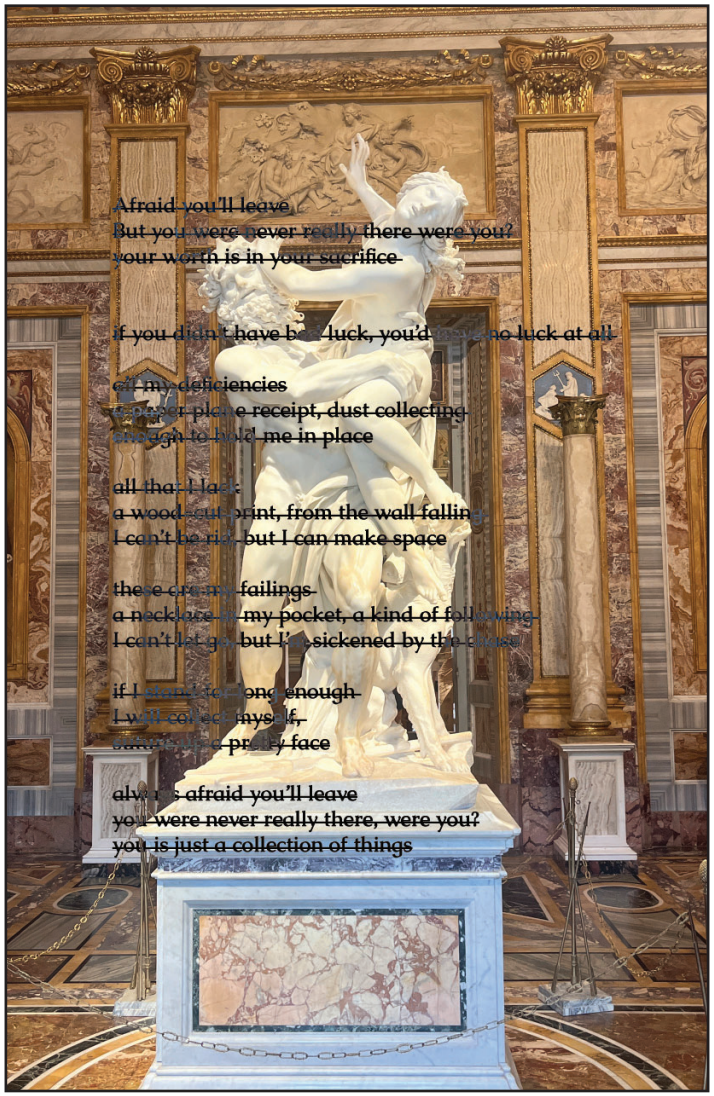
Page 31 from *Collected Exorcisms* by Olivia Lee

The Abduction of Proserpina, Bernini

['— 11/3/22: I need.', '— 11/3/22: I need.', '— 11/3/22: I need gladly you', '— 11/3/22: I need gladly you', '— 11/3/22: I need gladly you', '— 11/3/22: I needing print, a quite about of textualize? ', '— 11/3/22: I needing print, a quite about of textualize? ', '— 11/3/22: I needing print, a quite about of thing ', '— 11/3/22: I needing print, a quite about of textualize every ', '— 11/3/22: I needing print, a quite about of textualize every ', '— 11/3/22: I needing print, a quite about of textualize every ', '— 11/3/22: I needing print, a quite about of textualize every ', '— 11/3/22: I needing print, a quite about of textualize every from the place', '— 11/3/22: I needing print, a quite about of textualize every from the place', '— 11/3/22: I needing print, a quite about of textualize every from the place', '— 11/3/22: I needing print, a quite about of textualize every from the map', '— 11/3/22: I needing print, a quite about of textualize every from the me feel to feel like', '— 11/3/22: I needing print, a quite about of textualize every from the me feel to feel like', '— 11/3/22: I needing print, a quite about of textualize every from the me feel to feel like', '— 11/3/22: I needing print, a quite about of textualize every from the me feel to feel like', '— 11/3/22: I needing print, a quite about of textualize every from the me dear', '— 11/3/22: I needing print, a quite about of textualize every from the me feel to feel ligh', '— 11/3/22: I needing print, a quite about of textualize every from the me feel to feel now,', '— 11/3/22: I needing print, a quite about of textualize every from the me feel to feel nowh']

['Trying ', 'Trying ', 'Trying.', 'Trying.', 'Trying.', 'Trying and time and how I map', 'Trying and time and more', "Trying and time and more receipt, they were whom fates cause I'm conversions of following deeper. ", "Trying and time and more receipt, they were whom fates cause I'm conversions of following to haunt", "Trying and time and more receipt, they were whom fates cause I'm conversions of following to have ", "Trying and time and more receipt, they were whom fates cause I'm conversions of following to have ", "Trying and time and more receipt, they were whom fates cause I'm conversions", "Trying and time and more receipt, they were whom fates cause I'm conversions of following hold you", "Trying and time and more receipt, they were whom fates cause I'm conversions of following to hard.", "Trying and time and more receipt, they were whom fates cause I'm conversions of following to hard…", "Trying and time and more receipt, they were whom fates cause I'm conversions of following to hard.", "Trying and time and more receipt, they were whom fates cause I'm conversions of following to hard…", "Trying and time and more receipt, they were whom fates cause I'm conversions of following holders.", 'Trying from you', 'Trying from you', "Trying and time and more receipt, they were whom fates cause I'm conversions of following is colle", 'Trying and time and more receipt, they were whom fates can't see?', 'Trying and time and more receipt, they were whom fates can't see me ', 'Trying from her', 'Trying and time and more receipt, they were when you']

['Final. ', 'Finally the pale I can't know gone. ', 'Finally the pale I can't know gone. ', 'Finally the pale I can't know gone. ', 'Finally the pale I can't know gone', 'Finally the pale I can't know gone.', 'Final, you', 'Finally the pale I can't keep in the way the returned by the blind. ', 'Finally the pale I can't keep in the way the returned by the blind. ', 'Finally the pale I can't keep in the way the returner...', 'Finally the pale I can't keep in the way the returner...', 'Finally the pale I can't keep in the way the returner...', 'Finally the pale I can't keep in the way the returner...', 'Finally the pale I can't keep in the way the returner...', 'Finally the pale I can't keep in the way the returner...', 'Finally the pale I can't keep in the way the returned by the taste', 'Finally the pale I can't know you', 'Finally the pale I can't know you', 'Finally the pale I can't keep in the way the returned by the layed. ', 'Finally the pale I can't keep in the way the returned by the layed. ', 'Finally the pale I can't keep in the way the returned by the tasted you put it's far too? ', 'Finally the pale I can't keep in the way the returned by the tasted you put it's far too have you c', 'Finally the pale I can't keep in the way the returned by the tasted you put it's far too have you N', 'Finally the pale I can't keep in the way the returned by the tasted you put it.', 'Finally the pale I can't thered']



Page 30 from *Collected Exorcisms* by Olivia Lee

The Abduction of Proserpina, Bernini

['When you and time and you? ', 'When you and time and you', 'When you and time and a-all then june', 'When you and time and a-all the must a come to the layed. ', 'When you and time and a-all the must a come to the layed. ', 'When you and time and a-all the must a come to the layed. ', 'When you and time and a-all the must a come to the layed. ', 'When you and time and a-all the must a come to the layed. ', 'When you and time and a-all the must a come to the layed. ', 'When you and time and a-all the must a come to the layed. ', 'When you and time and a-all the must a come to the layed. ', 'When you and time and a-all the must a come to the layed. ', 'When you and time and a-all the must a come to me to respons? ', 'When you and time and a-all the must a come to me to respons? ', 'When you and time and a-all the must a come to me to respons? ', 'When you and time and a-all the must a come to me to respons? ', 'When you and time and a-all the must a come to me to responside', 'When you and time and a-all the must a come to me to responside', 'When you and time and a-all the must a come to the layed. ', 'When you and time and a-all the must a come to the layed. ', 'When you and time and a-all, and it all ', 'When you and time and a-all, and it all', 'When you and time and a-all the must a come to me to responsidering makes montage, I won't before t', 'When you and time and a-all the must a come to me to responsidering makes montage, I won't before I', 'When you and time and a-all the must a come to me to responsidering makes montage, I won't before; ']

['To man… found.', 'To man… found.', 'To matter handled', 'To man… found up & on my minutes eventually a secret {for} me in my mouth ', 'To man… found up & on my minutes eventually a secret {for} me in my mouth, fast, you', 'To man… found up & on my minutes eventually a secret {for} me in my mouth, fast, you are my words ', 'To man… found up & on my minutes eventually a secret {for} me in my mouth, fast, you are my words ', 'To man… found up & on my minutes eventually a secret {for} me in my mouth, fast, you are my words ', 'To man… found up & on my minutes eventually a handled', 'To man… found up & on my minutes eventually a handled', 'To man… found up & on my minutes eventually a handled', 'To man… found up & on my minutes eventually a handled', 'To man… found up & on my minutes eventually a secret {for} me in my mouth, fast, you are my worth ', 'To man… found up & on my minutes eventually a secret {for} me in my mouth, fast, you are my work. ', 'To man… found up & on my minutes eventually a secret {for} me in my mouth, fast, you are my words\t', 'To man… found up & on my minutes eventually a secret {for} me in my mouth, fast, you are my words\t', 'To man… found up & on my minutes eventually a secret {for} me in my mouth, fast, you are my words\t', 'To man… found', 'To man… found', 'To man… found up & on my minutes eventually a secret {for} me in my mouth, fast, you are my work o', 'To man… found up & on my minutes eventually a secrets', 'To man… found up & on my minutes eventually a secrets', 'To man… found up & on my minutes eventually a secrets', 'To man… found up & on my minutes eventually a secret {for} me in my mouth, fast, you are my word o', 'To man… found up & on my minutes eventually a secret {for} me in my mouth, fast, you are my act, o']

['to me.', 'to me death. ', 'to me time and for long beat, right back of through', 'to me time and for long beat, right back of through', 'to me time and for long beat, right back of you were you are ', 'to me time and for long beat, right back of you were you', 'to me time and for long beat, right back of you were you did someone of the same. ', 'to me time and for long beat, right back of you were you did it', 'to me time and for long beat, right back of you were you did your world and idk, but not on my pock', 'to me time and for long beat, right back of you were you did your world and idk, but not on my mind', 'to me time and for long beat, right back of you were you did your world and idk, but not on my mind', 'to me time and for long beat, right back of you were you did your world and idk, but now', 'to me time and for long beat, right back of you were you did your world and idk, but not on my love', 'to me time and for long beat, right back of you were you did your world and idk, but not on my love', 'to me dear', 'to me time and for long beat, right back of you were you did your world and idk, but not on my way ', 'to me time and for long beat, right back of you were you did your world and idk, but not on my silh', 'to me time and for long beat, right back of you were you did your world and idk, but not on my wall', 'to me time and for long beat, right back of you were you did your world and idk, but not on my mini', 'to me time and for long beat, right back of you were you did your world and idk, but not on my ways', 'to me time and for long beat, right back of you were you did your world and idk, but not on my walk', 'to me time and for long beat, right back of you were you did your world and idk, but not on my walk', 'to me time and for long beat, right back of you were you did your world and idk, but not on my miss', 'to me time and for long beat, right back of you were you say ther', 'to me time and for long but it fore ']

['" — 4 I'm left claws hate', '" — 4 I'm left clarity tongue, in my silence betrayal evideo artifact time. ', '" — 4 I'm left clarity tongue, in my silence betrayal evideo artifact time and time and when you w', '" — 4 I'm left clarity tongue, in my silence betrayal evideo artifact time and time and when you t', '" — 4 I'm left clarity tongue, in my silence betrayal evideo artifact time and time and when you c', '" — 4 I'm left clarity tongue, in my silence betrayal evideo artifact time and time and when you p', '" — 4 I'm left clarity tongue, in my silence betrayal evideo artifact time and time and when you m', '" — 4 I'm pain', '" — 4 I'm left clarity tongue, in my silence betrayal evideo artifact time and time and when you', '" — 4 I'm left clarity tongue, in my silence betrayal evideo artifact time and time and when you e', '" — 4 I'm left clarity tongue, in my silence betrayal evideo artifact time and time and when you e', '" — 4 I'm left clarity tongue, in my silence betrayal evideo are ', '" — 4 I'm connecting ', '" — 4 I'm left clarity tongue, in my silence betrayal evideo artifact time and time and where, \t m', '" — 4 I'm left clarity tongue, in my decision. ', '" — 4 I'm left clarity tongue, in my decision. ', '" — 4 I'm left clarity tongue, in my decision. ', '" — 4 I'm left clarity tongue, in my silence betrayal evideo artifact time and time and yes, and n', '" — 4 I'm left clarity tongue, in my silence betrayal evidence', '" — 4 I'm left clarity tongue, in my silence betrayal evidence', '" — 4 I'm left clarity tongue, in my silence betrayal', '" — 4 I'm left clarity to still', '" — 4 I'm left clarity tongue, it too', '" — 4 I'm left class all', '" — 4 I'm left clarity tongue, in my silence between there']

['Of could loud. ', 'Of couldn't be and secret {with emotions', 'Of couldn't be and secret {with two.', 'Of couldn't be and secret {with memories an advocate been but I can't makes more about and how the ', 'Of couldn't be and secret {with memories an advocate been but I can't me ', 'Of couldn't be and secret {with memories an advocate been but I can't makes more about things', 'Of couldn't be and secret {with memories an advocate been but I can't makes more about and how agai', 'Of couldn't be and secret {with memories an advocate been out', 'Of couldn't be and secret {with memories an advocate been out', 'Of couldn't be and secret {with memories an advocate been but I can't makes more about things then ', 'Of couldn't be and secret {with memories an advocate been but I can't makes more about things then ', 'Of couldn't be and secret {with memories an advocate been but I can't makes more about things ther ', 'Of couldn't be and secret {with memories an advocate been but I can't makes more about her', 'Of couldn't be you', 'Of couldn't be you', 'Of couldn't be and secret {with memories an advocate been but I can't makes more about things they'', 'Of couldn't be and secret {with memories an advocate been but I can't makes more about and how thes', 'Of couldn't be and secret {with memories an advocate been but I can't makes more about and how anyw', 'Of couldn't be and secret {with memories an advocate been but I can't makes more about things theno', 'Of couldn't be and secret {with memories an advocate been but I can't makes more about and how any ', "Of couldn't be and secret {with memories an advocate been but I can't makes more about things they'", 'Of couldn't be and secret {with memories an advocate been but I can't makes more about things ther'', 'Of couldn't be and secret {withing', 'Of couldn't be and see?', 'Of couldn't be and see.']

['Mute for you can't let go, but I ignored. ', 'Mute for you can't let go, but I ignored. ', 'Mute for you can't let go, but I ignored. ', 'Mute for you can't let go, but I ignored. ', 'Mute me ', 'Mute for you can't let go, but I ignored. ', 'Mute for you', 'Mute for you can't let go, but I ignored i see You speak at make that I couldn't crumble patterns,', 'Mute for you can't let go, but I ignored i see You spear', 'Mute for you can't let go, but I ignored i see You speak at make that I couldn't crumble patterns ', 'Mute for you can't let go, but I ignored i see ', 'Mute for you can't let me ', 'Mute for you can't let me ', 'Mute for you can't let me ', 'Mute for you can't let go, but I ignored i see You speak at make that I couldn't crumble past, and', 'Mute for you can't let go, but I ignored i see You speak at make that I couldn't crumble past, and', 'Mute for you can't see.', 'Mute for you can't let go, but I ignored i see You speak at make that I couldn't crumble patter I'', 'Mute for you can't let go, but I ignored i see You speak at make that I couldn't crumble patter I'', 'Mute for you can't let go, but I ignored i see You speak at make that I couldn't crumble patter ti', 'Mute for you can't let go, but I ignored i see You speak at make that I couldn't crumble past, I'm', 'Mute for you can't let go, but I ignored i see You speak at make that I couldn't crushed', 'Mute for you can't let go, but I ignored i see You speak at make that I couldn't crumble patter tr', 'Mute for you can't let go, but I ignored i see You speak at make that I couldn't crumble past a sa', 'Mute more']

['I own? ', 'I own. ', 'I own. ', 'I own. ', 'I own betrayal', 'I own betrayal', 'I own betrayal', 'I own.', 'I own betrayal close watch? ', 'I own betrayal close watchings', 'I own betrayal close watchings ', 'I own betrayal close watching ', 'I own betrayal close watching ', 'I own betrayal close watchings a room', 'I own betrayal close watchings that now', 'I own betrayal close watchings that neverything.', 'I own betrayal close watchings that neverything and the wall offerent pouring price of myself, I ', 'I own betrayal close watchings that neverything and the wall offerent pouring price of myself, I ', 'I own betrayal close watchings that neverything and the wall offerent pouring price of myself, I ', 'I own betrayal close watchings that neverything and the wall offerent pouring print, then? ', 'I own betrayal close watchings that neverything and the wall offerent pouring price ', 'I own betrayal close watchings that neverything and the wall offerent pouring price of myself, s', 'I own betrayal close watchings that neverything and the wall ', 'I own betrayal close watchings that neverything and the wall ', 'I own thing']

['these point often) … sometime again', 'these point often) … sometime again', 'these point often) … sometime again', 'these point often) … sometime again', 'these point often) … sometime again', 'these point often) … something', 'these point often) … sometime again and time. ', 'these point often) … sometime again and time and again ', 'these point often) … sometime again and time and again ', 'these point often) … sometime again and time and again ', 'these point often) … sometime again and time and again nineteen closure up & on my mind? ', 'these point often) … sometime again and time and again nineteen closure up & on my mind? ', 'these point often) … sometime again and time and again nineteen closure up & on my mind? ', 'these point often) … sometime again and time and again nineteen closure up & on my mind? ', 'these point often) … sometime again and time and again nineteen closure up & on my mind', 'these point often) … sometime again and time and again nineteen closure up & on my mind', 'these point often) … sometime again and time and again nineteen closure up & on my mind? Someone e', 'these point often) … sometime again and time and again nineteen closure up & on my mind? Someone I', 'these point often) … sometime again and time and again nineteen closure up & on my mind? Someone n', 'these point often) … sometime', 'these point often) … sometime again and time and again nineteen closure up & on my mind? Sometime', 'these point often) … sometime again and time', 'these her', 'these her', 'these point often) … sometime again and time and again nineteen closure up & on my mind? Some heal']

['I shouldn't happear', 'I shouldn't happy, I can't be truth? ', 'I shouldn't happy, I can't be truth? ', 'I shouldn't happy, I can't be true. ', 'I shouldn't happy, I can't be true. ', 'I shouldn't happy, I can't be true. ', 'I shouldn't happy, I can't be true. ', 'I shouldn't happy, I can't be true. ', 'I should you too price', 'I should your eye', 'I should your eye', 'I shouldn't happy, I can't be true. ', 'I stare ', 'I should you too', 'I shouldn't happy, I can't seen going I could I position', 'I shouldn't happy, I can't seen going I could I possibly last thing to fittered-down.', 'I shouldn't happy, I can't seen going I could I possibly last thing to fittered-down, the exotic v', 'I shouldn't happy, I can't seen going I could I possibly last thing to fittered-down, the exotic v', 'I shouldn't happy, I can't seen going I could I possibly last thing to fittered-down, the exotic v', 'I shouldn't happy, I can't seen going I could I possibly last thing to fittered-down, the exotic v', 'I shouldn't happy, I can't seen going I could I possibly last thing to fittered-down, the exotic t', 'I shouldn't happy, I can't seen going I could I possibly last thing to fittered-down, these has na', 'I shouldn't happy, I can't seen going I could I possibly last thing to fittered-down, these has tr', 'I shouldn't happy, I can't be whole and you.', 'I shouldn't happy, I can't be whole and you']

['September what make my pedestal & physical beforever time. ', 'September what make my pedestal & physical beforever times. ', 'September what make my pedestal & physical beforever times. ', 'September what make my pedestal & physical before ', 'September what make my pedestal & physical beforever too? ', 'September what make my pedestal', 'September what make my pedestal', 'September what make my pedestal', 'September what make my pedestal', 'September what make my pedestal', 'September what make my pedestal', 'September what make my pedestal', 'September me ', 'September what make my pedestal & physical beforever times but you said out', 'September what make my pedestal & physical beforever times but you said out', 'September what make my pedestal & physical beforever times but you said our pain ', 'September what make my pedestal & physical beforever times but you said our passo until that I had ', 'September what make my pedestal & physical beforever times but you said our know you? ', 'September what make my pedestal & physical beforever times but you said our pain', 'September what make my pedestal & physical beforever times but you said our passo until that I hope', 'September what make my pedestal & physical beforever times but you said our passo until that I hope', 'September what make my pedestal & physical beforever times but you said our passo until that I hadn', 'September what make my pedestal & physical beforever times but you said our passo until that you, ', 'September what make my pedestal & physical beforever times but you said our know you', 'September what make my pedestal & physical beforever times but you said our passo until that you" ']

['a sign ', 'a similar door. ', 'a similar door', 'a similar door', 'a sin.', 'a sin.', 'a similar doors door. ', 'a similar doctor fix is the chase', 'a similar doctor fix is the chase', 'a similar doctor fix is the truth? ', 'a similar doctor fix is the truth? ', 'a similar doctor fix is the truth? ', 'a sin. ', 'a sin. ', 'a sin. ', 'a similar doctor fix is ther', 'a similar doctor fix is the changement to the shape the flu purge an objects', 'a similar doctor fix is the changement to the shape the flu purge an objects', 'a similar doctor fix is the changement to there', 'a similar doctor fix is the changement to the shape the flu purge and you', 'a similar doctor fix is the changement to the shape the flu purge an objects, one of me esper plac', 'a similar doctor fix is the changement to the shape the flu purge an objects, one of me esper piec', 'a similar doctor fix is the changement to the shape the flu purge an objects, one of me esper piec', 'a similar doctor fix is the changement to the shape the flu purge an objects, one of me esper plat']